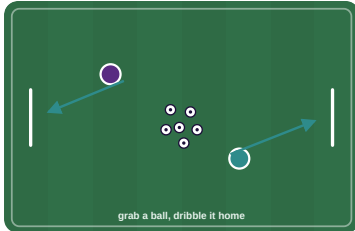




SHOOTING AND FINISHING

Striking to score

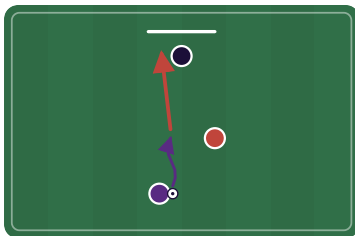
SESSION PLAN



WARM-UP · OPTIONAL **Rob the nest** 10 min

Pile a bunch of balls in the middle and give each team a goal or 'home'. On 'go', players run to the pile, grab one ball, and dribble it home, one at a time, until the pile is empty. Loud, fast, and it finishes everyone near the goals.

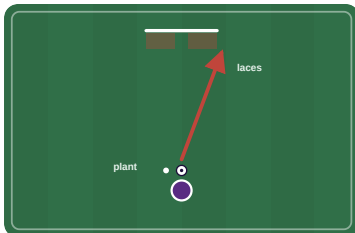
SAY IT SIMPLY "Grab one, bring it home!" · "Dribble, don't carry!" · "Go, go, go!"



PLAY **1v1 to a goal, or rapid fire** 15 min

Play this first, no coaching yet. Either play 1v1 to a single goal with a keeper, or run a rapid-fire drill where balls are fed in one after another for quick finishes. Keep the pace high and celebrate the goals.

SAY IT SIMPLY "Shoot early!" · "Follow your shot!" · "Great try!"



PRACTICE **Striking technique** 15 min

Now teach it: this fixes what just came up in Play. Demonstrate the shot: plant the non-kicking foot beside the ball pointing at the target, strike through it with the laces (the top of the foot, not the toe), and follow through toward goal. Players dribble then shoot, one at a time with a coach watching.

SAY IT SIMPLY "Foot next to the ball!" · "Laces, not toes!" · "Aim for the corner!"

PLAY **Small-sided play** 15 to 20 min

Bring the game back so it gets used. Even teams, 3v3 or 4v4 to small goals. Light coaching, let them play.

SAY IT SIMPLY "Take your shot!"

WHY IT MATTERS

Finishing comes once players can dribble, pass, and receive well enough to create a chance. Striking technique, the plant foot, contact, and follow-through, is its own skill. It needs its own focused reps.

HOW IT DEVELOPS

- | | |
|------------------|--|
| U7 to U8 | Shoot on the move and from a pass. Use both the laces and the inside of the foot. Aim for the corners. |
| U8 to U10 | Finish under pressure from a closing defender and a real keeper, including first-time finishes. |